

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ J 10 4

♥ Q 7 6

♦ Q 10 9 6

♣ A 8 5

♠ A Q 8 6 2

♥ J 5 3

♦ 7 4

♣ K Q 2



♠ 5

♥ A K 10 9

♦ J 8 3 2

♣ 10 9 4 3

♠ K 9 7 3

♥ 8 4 2

♦ A K 5

♣ J 7 6

SOUTH has just 11 points, not enough to open the bidding. But when NORTH opens 1♠ SOUTH should show her "almost opening strength" by jumping to 3♠.

NORTH has just 13 points, and knowing SOUTH has less than 13 he passes.

*West**North**East**South*

Pass

1♠

Pass

3♠

All Pass

3♠ by North

Lead: ♥K

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 7 3
♥ Q 8 6 4 2
♦ A 8 6
♣ K 9 5

♠ A 9 6 5

♥ J 9

♦ 9 2

♣ A J 7 3 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 10 8 2

♥ A K 7 5 3

♦ K Q 5

♣ Q 6

♠ K Q J 4

♥ 10

♦ J 10 7 4 3

♣ 10 8 4

After EAST opens with 1♥, WEST has a small "dilemma". With 11 points she really is only strong enough to make a jump raise to 3♥. But, with five trumps the hand deserves more. So she just bids 4♥ instead.

Usually, no matter what your strength, when you have five cards in the Major suit that your partner opens with you should just jump right to game.

*West**North**East**South*

1♥

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by East

Lead: ♠K

Board 3

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 4
 ♥ K Q 10 6 3
 ♦ 10 4 2
 ♣ A 7 4

♠ Q J 7 5
 ♥ A
 ♦ A K Q 3
 ♣ K 10 6 2



♠ A 6 2
 ♥ 9 8 5 4
 ♦ J 7 5
 ♣ 9 8 5

♠ K 10 8 3
 ♥ J 7 2
 ♦ 9 8 6
 ♣ Q J 3

NORTH has 19 points, but no 5-card Major suit. With two 4-card minor suits she should start with 1♦.

SOUTH has a poor hand, but with 7 points he must respond. His first priority is to show a Major suit so he responds 1♠.

NORTH now knows that ♠s will be trumps, so she revalues her hand to 21 points, enough for game. She bids 4♠.

West	North	East	South
	1♦	Pass	1♠
Pass	4♠		
All Pass			
4♠ by South			
Lead: ♥K			

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ K Q J 7 4
♥ K Q 2
♦ A J 6
♣ 9 3

♠ 8 2

♥ 10 6 3

♦ 10 9 4 3 2

♣ J 10 2



♠ 10 9 6 3
♥ 7 5 4
♦ Q 7
♣ A K 6 4

♠ A 5

♥ A J 9 8

♦ K 8 5

♣ Q 8 7 5

NOTE: There is a better way to bid this hand using special conventions.

WEST has 17 points, but with a 5-card Major opens 1♠ rather than 1NT. EAST isn't quite strong enough for a jump raise, so she bids 2♠. WEST has enough extra to make a try for game, so she invites with 3♠. EAST has enough extra to accept the invitation, bids 4♠.

West	North	East	South
1♠	Pass	2♠	Pass
3♠	Pass	4♠	

All Pass
4♠ by West
Lead: ♣J